

LOST FRAMES

OFFICIAL BRAND IDENTITY & STYLE GUIDE

1. EXECUTIVE OVERVIEW & PHILOSOPHY

Lost Frames is a premium, high-production-value audio series and digital publication dedicated to the preservation, analysis, and celebration of overlooked masterpieces in world cinema. By blending academic-level formal film criticism with engaging narrative storytelling, the series reconstructs the historical contexts, artistic breakthroughs, and cultural impacts of films that have slipped from mainstream awareness.

As a brand, *Lost Frames* stands for editorial independence, uncompromising technical execution, and archival reverence. Every touchpoint—from the primary podcast feed and marketing materials to the digital distribution repository (lostframes.show) and live screenings—must reflect a cohesive aesthetic that feels both historically informed and strictly contemporary. This guide establishes the mandatory visual and typographic rules to maintain brand integrity across all channels.

1.1 Brand Pillars

- **Cinematic Archival Reverence:** Visual assets and tone should pay homage to the physical texture of traditional celluloid film, physical prints, and classic editorial design without succumbing to cheap nostalgia.
- **Uncompromising Critical Clarity:** Our commentary is precise, analytical, and structured. The presentation must reflect this clarity through generous whitespace, structured geometric alignments, and legible layouts.
- **Modernist Independent Spirit:** We champion the rule-breakers of cinema history (such as Wong Kar-wai, the French New Wave, and independent pioneers). The brand visual language balances timeless classicism with bold, intentional accents.

2. VISUAL ASSETS & ARTWORK CONFIGURATIONS

The visual presence of *Lost Frames* on digital audio platforms is the primary conduit for listener acquisition and brand recognition. Consistency in artwork sizing, scaling, and composition ensures that the brand remains recognizable across various viewport constraints, from mobile application grids to large web headers.

CRITICAL LOGO & FEED DISTRIBUTION MANDATE:

Show artwork: **1:1 square crop required** for all primary cover art submissions. Under no circumstances may a landscape (16:9), panoramic, or portrait crop be approved or utilized as the primary show profile or feed banner image.

This strict standard complies directly with global podcast distribution specifications (including Apple Podcasts, Spotify, and standard RSS metadata structures). The 1:1 master asset must be rendered at a native resolution of exactly 3000 x 3000 pixels, utilizing the core color palette.

Secondary marketing crops—such as wide 16:9 promo banners, YouTube video cards, or slide-deck headers—are permitted solely for contextual promotional placement and must never be substituted for the official show icon. If an external designer or internal collaborator submits an alternative crop configuration (such as a 16:9 widescreen adaptation) for sign-off as the primary show cover, it must be rejected immediately to preserve compliance with our platform architectures.

2.1 Graphic Composition Rules

- The main title "LOST FRAMES" must occupy the upper or central third of the 1:1 canvas, utilizing the authorized modernist serif face.
- A minimum safe area padding of 10% must be maintained along all four borders to prevent truncation by operating system overlays or circular framing masks within player UIs.
- Background textures must remain subtle; high-contrast geometric grain is acceptable, but it should never compete with the legibility of the title text.

3. CORE COLOR PALETTE

The *Lost Frames* color scheme draws direct inspiration from mid-century editorial film journals and the physical architecture of classic screening rooms. It relies on a high-contrast relationship between a deep, shadow-like neutral tone and a bright, safety-inspired cinematic accent.

Primary Dark Navy

Hex: **#0B192C**

Application: Primary text, structural backgrounds, headings, master cover art background fields.

Background Warm White

Hex: **#FBFAF8**

Application: Main document body canvas, website backgrounds, email newsletters. Deliberately off-white to reduce eye strain.

Film-Frame Orange Accent

Hex: **#E65F2B**

Application: Hyperlinks, key metric highlights, design borders, visual callouts, and interactive state elements.

4. TYPOGRAPHY GUIDANCE

Our typographic system establishes a strict visual hierarchy designed to reinforce the duality of historical film discussion and structured digital publishing.

MANDATORY TYPOGRAPHY FRAMEWORK:

Always employ a **modernist serif for titles** and a clean, high-legibility **system sans for body** text layouts. This creates a balanced editorial contrast that echoes high-end film monographs.

4.1 Hierarchy Specifications

1. **Main Titles (H1):** Set in a prominent modernist serif font (e.g., Georgia, Times New Roman, or localized editorial serifs). Tracking should be tight (-0.02em), with an explicit dark navy fill.
2. **Section Headers (H2 & H3):** Set in a modernist serif face. H2 elements must include a structural 4px left-border accent using the Film-Frame Orange accent color to frame the incoming content block.
3. **Body Text & Documentation:** Rendered in a neutral, highly readable system sans-serif typeface (such as system-ui, -apple-system, Helvetica, or Arial). This ensures universal cross-platform rendering consistency across web applications, e-books, and automated PDF outputs.

5. EDITORIAL VOICE & COHESIVENESS

The brand voice must balance academic authority with narrative accessibility. Avoid sensationalism or generic clickbait phrases. When referencing film titles, directors, or years, cross-reference data directly with verified archives (such as TMDb or Criterion indices) to prevent factual drift.

Sponsorship alignments must also conform to this standard. Pre-roll and mid-roll delivery tones should be calm, authoritative, and direct, maintaining a clear separation from commercial hyperbole while respecting the specific locked parameters defined by our premium brand partners.

6. DIGITAL FEED & REPOSITORY STANDARDS

The digital architecture supporting the series relies on a static repository framework deployed at `lostframes.show`. To ensure consistency between visual assets and technical implementations, specific metadata tags and open-graph frameworks must be hardcoded into every deployment phase.

When pushing new episode releases or landing pages to the production stream, all image assets referenced in the document header must link directly back to the canonical 1:1 square master cover. Wide layouts or alternate banners are restricted to sub-page body wrappers and must never mask the main repository entry icons.

Asset Key	Dimension Constraint	MIME Type	Deployment Context
podcast_cover_master	3000 x 3000 px (1:1)	image/jpeg	RSS Feed Metadata / Main Distribution
open_graph_default	1200 x 630 px (1.91:1)	image/png	Social Graph Previews / Repository Root
newsletter_header	600 x 200 px (3:1)	image/jpeg	Direct Email Campaign Templates

7. LIVE SCREENING & EVENT PRESENTATION

For off-feed activations, including regional film festival pop-ups, community retrospective series, and premium special presentation events (such as the Cobblestone theater screenings), physical print layouts must mirror our digital typographic balance.

7.1 Ticketing & Collateral Layouts

Printed tickets, digital gate passes, and programs distributed to VIP premium tiers must preserve a minimum 20% whitespace block. Titles are to be presented in high-contrast dark navy over warm white cardstock, with any seating categories or scheduling times highlighted using the film-frame orange accent line. No illustrative gradients are permitted on physical materials.

8. SPONSOR INTEGRATION & PROMOTIONAL ALIGNMENT

To protect the editorial integrity and listener trust of *Lost Frames*, all third-party promotional assets, sponsored content blocks, and premium partner read-outs must comply with strict aesthetic separation boundaries.

Sponsor logos displayed on secondary web modules must be presented in monochrome variants (either completely matched to our Primary Dark Navy or dropped into clean grayscale). This maintains a singular, cohesive aesthetic presence and guarantees that commercial identities do not disrupt the editorial continuity of our archival film materials.